

Emergency Decision Unit Pathway

Alcohol Pathway

Date DD/MM/YY

Patient details

Full
name

DoB

Unit
number

(use sticker if available)

Inclusion criteria

- Alcohol Misuse identified as the Primary Problem requiring a period of observation and / or "sobering up" to enable safe discharge +/- for further assessment by the Alcohol Care Team (ACT)/ Turning Point

Exclusion criteria

- Medical problem requiring admission elsewhere
- EWS>5
- "Severe" withdrawal likely to need more than 12hrs as an inpatient
- GMAWS >8 (see trust alcohol withdrawal policy for details)
- Wernickes Encephalopathy
- Head Injury (Must be evaluated for this in the ED and also be on EDU Head Injury pathway)
- High probability of withdrawal seizures- check if had on previous Hx and attendances

Identify type of drinker – increasing risk, high risk, binge or dependent. (If able to do so or wait till sober).

Assess whether withdrawing from alcohol. Use GMAWS score. Full UHL guideline available on insight. Prescribe diazepam if indicated as per guideline (lorazepam if exceptional patient group)

Providing the patient consents, refer to the ACT (via e-referral on Nerve Centre).

If any further investigations or treatments are still outstanding (eg glueing of a head wound) this MUST be documented in the EDU plan below and stated clearly in the e-referral to EDU

EDU PLAN:

Management Checklist

(all patients should have)

None of the above exclusion criteria	
Patent IV cannula if clinical indication for this	
Prescribe Pabrinex and benzodiazepine PRN, if identified as alcohol dependent	
Referral to ACT made or reason in plan for not doing this	

On Discharge (all patients should have)

Seen ACT or referral made to them if patient consents	
Been given withdrawal management and gradual reduction advice – if dependent drinker.	
Been given alcohol advice leaflet	

Referring Clinician

Print name

Signatures

NB: Pathway MUST be filled in and signed by the referring clinician. (e) Referral to EDU MUST only take place after discussion with a Consultant or the EPIC who will enter "EDU admission approved" in the progress notes on Nerve Centre. Patients will not be accepted by EDU until this has been done.